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Difference between User Level thread and Kernel Level thread

Difficulty Level : Easy • Last Updated : 02 Nov, 2021

User level thread

User thread are implemented by users.
OS doesn't recognize user level threads.
Implementation of User threads is easy.

Context switch time is less.

Context switch requires no hardware support.

If one user level thread perform blocking operation then entire process will be blocked.

User level threads are designed as dependent threads.

Example : Java thread, POSIX threads.

Kernel level thread

kernel threads are implemented by OS.
Kernel threads are recognized by OS.
Implementation of Kernel thread is complicated.

Context switch time is more.

Hardware support is needed.

If one kernel thread perform blocking operation then another thread can continue execution.

Kernel level threads are designed as independent threads.

Example : Window Solaris.

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